

Call for Expressions of Interest	
<i>Date of Issue:</i>	September 2026
<i>Expected Completion Date:</i>	May 2027
<i>Project Title:</i>	Make PhenoAssistant Nice Again
<i>Company:</i>	UON
Contact Details	
<i>Lead Contact:</i>	Valerio Giuffrida
<i>Lead E-mail:</i>	Valerio.giuffrida@nottingham.ac.uk
<i>Additional Contact:</i>	Additional contact name
<i>E-mail:</i>	Additional contact e-mail
<i>Additional Contact:</i>	Additional contact name
<i>E-mail:</i>	Additional contact e-mail
<i>Additional Contact:</i>	Additional contact name
<i>E-mail:</i>	Additional contact e-mail
Additional Info	
<i>Students must sign NDA:</i>	☐
<i>Project uses personal data:</i>	☐
<i>Custom hardware required:</i>	☒ If Applicable: School GPU Cluster
<i>Relevant research areas (if applicable)¹:</i>	AI
Project Background Information	
PhenoAssistant (https://github.com/vios-s/PhenoAssistant/) is a multi-agentic AI system to support plant biologists and researchers to analyse (mostly) imaging data of plants. This work has been published in Nature Communication journal (https://www.nature.com/articles/s41467-026-71090-y). Since its publication, the code has undertaken a major restructuring implementing the Model Context Protocol (MCP). However, from a software engineering point of view, PhenoAssistant is mostly a backend. The purpose of this project is to build a ChatGPT/Claude/Gemini-like user interface to facilitate the user to leverage the powerful AI models that PhenoAssistant expose. The workflow is rather simple: each user needs to login, chat histories need to be stored in a database (eg supabase), data uploaded also need to be stored, as well as any analysis results. PhenoAssistant also generates pipeline for data analysis and the reproduction of these workflows is a must-have	

¹ An overview of different research areas in the school of computer science can be found [here](#).

Requirements	
<i>The group must provide:</i> - React GUI for PhenoAssistant - Authentication pathways - Deployment instruction/manual - Demo	
Skills	
<i>Highly desirable:</i> React Web programming Python Linux/SLURM	<i>Desirable:</i> MCP
Submission / Award information	
<i>Date of Submission:</i>	September 2026
<i>Date of Pitch:</i>	October 2026
<i>Notification of award:</i>	October 2026

For further information on this proposal, the team representative should in the first instance e-mail the lead contact stated above at the e-mail address provided.